UI elements and the Hotwire framework for interacting with our Rails server. Import these frameworks at the top of `SceneDelegete`:

ch01_01/ios/HikingJournal/SceneDelegate.swift

```
import HotwireNative
import UIKit
```

Add a `baseURL` Variable

Then declare a variable that points to the Rails server via `let`, making it a *constant*. Swift encourages immutability whenever possible. Knowing that a variable can never change often makes it easier to understand how data will flow through the code in your app.

ch01_02/ios/HikingJournal/SceneDelegate.swift

```
import HotwireNative
import UIKit

» let baseURL = URL(string: "http://localhost:3000")!
```

There's something to notice with the `baseURL` variable: there's an exclamation point at the end of the `URL` initializer. This is because `URL(string:)` returns an *optional* value. Optional variables behave like Ruby ones—they can also be `nil`. Non-optional variables in Swift must *always* contain a value and can never be `nil`.

For `baseURL`, the compiler can't guarantee the arbitrary string we pass in is a valid URL, so the check happens at runtime. If it's invalid, it returns `nil`. Adding an exclamation point tells the compiler to *force unwrap* the optional variable, returning a non-optional `URL` class.